

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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September 16, 2026

Dear Nicole Fiorentino,

I am applying for the School Operations & Classroom Assistant role at Masterminds Academy in Los Altos. You are hiring a founding-team hybrid: school operations, parent-facing front of house, and classroom support as the California campus opens around October 15, 2026. I run a small consultancy end to end, so I already own intake, calendars, records, and the unowned task that keeps a small operation moving.

I do not have preschool or elementary tenure, California ECE units, or Mandarin. I do have conversational Spanish, EMT training in personal care (2024), a Cognitive Science certificate, and availability to start around October 15. I want to own the daily operations that let 5-6 student pods and specialist teachers run on time, and learn classroom support from your teachers inside the school's Intellectual, Physical and Social Excellence model.

Here is how I would show up in the operations half of the job:

- Front of house: First reply for every consulting client, by email and calendar, with one owner through handoff. That is the habit I would bring to family welcome, parent inquiries, and routing tours to the right person.
- Admin systems: Google Workspace and Notion for schedules and records. At IBM I wrote the release notes that walked non-technical stakeholders through each change.
- Ownership: I map implicit workflows, then train the people who run them. An MSP's risk-assessment processing time fell 98% once their team could extend the work themselves.
- Campus ops: As rush chair and on executive council at Alpha Phi Delta, I kept academic records, wrote work-order RFPs, hosted events, and owned the membership funnel from first conversation to signed bid.

Coordinating specialist teachers and external providers is calendar and vendor work I already do when a delivery has more than one owner. EZ-AI, the training I delivered, is adult enablement, not a classroom year. I am prepared for outdoor play, transitions, after-school, and age-appropriate personal care, including toileting. I live in Emeryville and can work Monday through Friday, 7:30 a.m. to 4:30 p.m.

Thank you for your time. I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker